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Course: ITC-C103

Section: BSIT-102I

Date: September 19, 2026

WW2 – M3U1 Midterms Assignment 7

1. When building a new desktop computer or upgrading an old one, what is the single most important component that determines the range of parts you can use for upgrades in the future?

The motherboard is the most important because it connects the different computer components. It also determines what processors, memory, expansion cards, and other parts can be installed.

2. You need to choose a new device to store all your school projects, photos, and personal documents long-term. What type of computer component provides persistent storage, and what are two common examples of it?

The fixed disk or storage device provides persistent storage. Two common examples are HDD (Hard Disk Drive) and SSD (Solid State Drive). An SSD is faster and more durable, while an HDD is an older mechanical type of storage.

3. A friend wants to know how fast their new computer's CPU is. How is a CPU's speed measured, and what is the function of a heatsink in keeping the CPU from overheating?

CPU speed is measured in gigahertz (GHz). A heatsink helps remove heat from the CPU. It usually works together with a fan to keep the processor at a safe temperature.

4. You want to add a powerful graphics card to your desktop computer for gaming. What type of expansion slot should you look for on the motherboard to ensure the fastest connection?

I would look for a PCI Express (PCIe) slot, especially a PCIe x16 slot, because it is the standard used for graphics cards and provides high bandwidth.

5. You need to change a core setting on your computer, such as the boot order or system clock, before the operating system even loads. What is the name of the program you would access to do this, and how do you typically get to it when you first turn on the computer.

I would access the UEFI Setup Utility. It can be opened by pressing a specific key during startup, before the operating system loads. UEFI is the modern replacement for BIOS and is used to change important startup settings.